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United States Patent Application Publication

20250279526

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

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Battery-Operated Machining Device

Abstract

A battery-operated machining device includes a housing part, which at least partially surrounds an electronic unit and/or an electric motor for operating the machining device, a main handle, which is movably connected to the housing part for vibrational decoupling, and at least one electromechanical interface, which is arranged on the main handle and is provided for receiving an interchangeable battery pack such that the interchangeable battery pack can be released without tools, wherein the electromechanical interface has a protective housing, the envelope of which completely surrounds the received interchangeable battery pack. The protective housing is fixedly connected to the housing part and movably coupled to the main handle.

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Family ID: 96738252

Appl. No.: 19/062691

Filed: February 25, 2025

Foreign Application Priority Data

DE 10 2024 201 896.1

Feb. 29, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H01M50/242 (20210101); B25F5/00 (20060101); H01M50/244 (20210101); H01M50/247 (20210101); H01M50/262 (20210101)

U.S. Cl.:

Background/Summary

[0001] This application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 to application no. DE 10 2024 201 896.1, filed on Feb. 29, 2024 in Germany, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

[0002] The disclosure relates to a battery-operated machining device.

BACKGROUND

[0003] From EP 3 653 344 A1, a battery-operated machining device in the form of a hand-held power tool is known, which comprises a housing part, the housing part at least partially surrounding an electronic unit and/or an electric motor for operating the machining device. For vibrational decoupling during a machining operation, a main handle of the machining device is movably connected to the housing part. An electromechanical interface for receiving an interchangeable battery pack such that the interchangeable battery pack can be released without tools is also arranged on the main handle, the electromechanical interface being surrounded by a protective bow which is fixedly connected to the main handle and which, when the interchangeable battery pack is received in the interface, surrounds the interchangeable battery pack on both sides, so that fall energy is at least partially absorbed by the protective bow and kept away from the interchangeable battery pack.

[0004] EP 2 080 594 A1 shows a battery-operated machining device which is in the form of a cordless screwdriver and in which the electromechanical interface arranged at a lower end of a main handle is surrounded by a protective housing fixedly connected to the main handle, such that the envelope of the protective housing completely surrounds the received interchangeable battery pack.

[0005] It is the object of the disclosure to ensure, in comparison with the prior art, improved protection for an interchangeable battery pack received in the electromechanical interface arranged on the main handle of a battery-operated machining device, in conjunction with the lowest possible vibrational load for the operator of the machining device.

SUMMARY

[0006] To achieve the above object, it is provided that the protective housing is fixedly connected to the housing part of the machining device, which housing part surrounds the electronic unit and/or the electric motor, and that the protective housing is movably coupled to the main handle. Thus, in a particularly advantageous manner, the protective housing can absorb any impacts and falls particularly well by dissipating the impact energy into the housing part, while a high level of vibrational decoupling can be achieved as a result of the movable coupling to the main handle. In this context, “the housing part” as part of the housing and “the housing part” as a separate, independent part should not be explicitly differentiated. This expression should be understood to cover both meanings.

[0007] For example, a battery-operated machining device is to be understood as a battery-operated power tool for machining workpieces using an electrically driven insertion tool. The battery-operated machining device can be designed not only as a hand-held power tool, but also as a stationary machine tool. Typical machine tools in this context include hand-held or stationary drills, screwdrivers, impact drills, planers, angle grinders, orbital sanders, polishing machines, or the like. However, suitable battery-operated machining devices also include garden tools and construction equipment, e.g. lawn mowers, lawn trimmers, branch saws, tilling and trenching machines, blowers, robotic breakers and excavators, etc., as well as measuring devices, e.g. laser rangefinders,

wall scanners, etc. Furthermore, the disclosure is applicable to battery-operated household appliances such as vacuum cleaners, blenders, etc.

[0008] The energy supply of the battery-operated machining device is carried out by way of an interchangeable battery pack inserted into the at least one electromechanical interface. For this purpose, the interchangeable battery pack has an electromechanical interface which is complementary to said electromechanical interface. By way of these interfaces, the interchangeable battery pack and the battery-operated machining device can be frictionally and/or interlockingly releasably connected to each other. The term “releasable connection” is understood in particular to mean a connection that can be released and established without a tool, i.e., manually. The exact configuration of the electromechanical interfaces with their mechanical guide elements for the frictional and/or interlocking, releasable connection and with the electrical contacts used for energy and/or data transfer is not intended to be the subject of this disclosure. A person skilled in the art will choose a suitable embodiment for the electromechanical interfaces depending on the power class or voltage class of the battery-operated machining device and/or of the interchangeable battery pack, so that no further details will be given here. In addition, it should be noted that the disclosure is also applicable to battery-operated machining devices having a plurality of electromechanical interfaces for a plurality of interchangeable battery packs.

[0009] In a further development it is provided that the protective housing comprises, for movable coupling to the main handle, a mechanism which is configured to guide the main handle laterally and to support the protective housing on the main handle in the event of a fall or impact. In this way, a precise machining operation along a working axis of the machining device can be ensured, while, in the event of a fall or impact, the impact energy can be dissipated not only into the housing part fixedly connected to the protective housing but also into the main handle. Thus, by distributing the impact energy accordingly, the risk of damage to the machining device can be effectively reduced or completely avoided.

[0010] The protective housing has, on each of at least two outer sides, a contact surface in which the mechanism is arranged as a preferably removable support element. Because the mechanism can be removed from the main handle and/or from the protective housing, a simplified way to replace the main handle or the protective housing in the event of a defect is provided. In addition, it is possible to influence the degree of support on the main handle, for example in order to briefly allow very high vibrations without the main handle striking the protective housing. This may be advantageous, for example, in the case of machine guidance of the machining device in a guide device provided for this purpose.

[0011] Optimized support of the protective housing on the main handle can further be achieved when the contact surfaces of the protective housing are inclined towards the main handle. If the protective housing and/or the housing part each consist of two half shells along a central plane extending in the direction of the working axis of the machining device, the protective housing can be pushed towards the central plane in the event of a fall or impact so that the half shells do not gape apart. In addition, the half shells enable easier replacement of the individual parts of the machining device in the case of service and an advantageous assembly sequence.

[0012] In a further development, it is provided that at least one of the support elements is coupled to the main handle by way of a retaining element, in particular an elastic damping element or a screw. In this way it is possible, for example, to avoid noises in the event of abrupt impact of the support element against the protective housing. In addition, this enables simple replacement of the support element.

[0013] Alternatively, it can be provided that at least one of the support elements is fixedly connected, in particular integrally, to the main handle. In this way, it can be ensured that the support element is captively retained. An integral connection is intended in this context to mean that the connected elements cannot be non-destructively separated from one another. Particularly preferably, the support element and the main handle are made of the same material.

[0014] In addition, the protective housing and the housing part may also be formed as single piece in order to better dissipate the impact energy from the protective housing into the housing part. In this case the protective housing is integrally formed on the housing part, for example in the course of a plastic injection molding process or the like. Alternatively, the protective housing may also be fixedly connected to the housing part by a frictional connection, in particular a screw connection. The protective housing and/or the housing part are preferably made of a plastic material, for example PA6GF35, ABS or an elastomer. In addition or alternatively, another natural material, a metal (steel, aluminum, etc.) or a mix of materials is also conceivable.

[0015] It is further provided that the protective housing has a honeycomb structure which, in particular, is irregular. This results in reduced weight of the machining device and further improved dissipation of the impact energy together with increased intrinsic stability, in comparison with a full-volume or solid protective housing. An irregular honeycomb structure is to be understood to mean that the individual honeycombs can have different sizes and shapes. Thus, it is conceivable that, in regions in which greater stability is required, the honeycombs are more closely meshed and smaller and may have a structure that deviates from a hexagonal honeycomb structure.

Description

EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

Brief Description of the Drawings

[0016] The disclosure is explained below with reference to FIGS. 1 through 7 by way of example, wherein identical reference numbers in the drawings indicate identical components having an identical function.

Shown are:

[0017] FIG. 1: a side view of an exemplary embodiment of a battery-operated machining device in the form of a hammer drill, having a protective housing according to the disclosure for an interchangeable battery pack inserted into an electromechanical interface of the hammer drill,

[0018] FIG. 2: the exemplary embodiment according to FIG. 1 in a sectional view along a central plane extending parallel to a working axis,

[0019] FIG. 3: a perspective partial view of the hammer drill according to FIGS. 1 and 2, the perspective partial view comprising a main handle, a housing part and the protective housing,

[0020] FIG. 4: a section through the protective housing according to FIG. 3 perpendicular to the central plane, and

[0021] FIG. 5: a top plan view of the protective housing of the hammer drill according to FIGS. 1 to 4.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0022] FIGS. 1 and 2 show a battery-operated machining device 12 which is in the form of a hammer drill 10 and which is supplied with energy by an interchangeable battery pack 14, in a side view and in a section along a central plane 18 extending parallel to a working axis 16 of the machining device 12. For better orientation, coordinate crosses with the designations “rear”, “front”, “bottom” and “top” are shown in FIGS. 1 and 2. However, these designations are not to be understood as limiting the disclosure and refer primarily to a working direction extending along the working axis 16 and thus to the holding of the hammer drill 10 by an operator, in particular during a machining operation.

[0023] The interchangeable battery pack 14 can be frictionally and/or interlockingly releasably connected to the hammer drill 10 by way of correspondingly designed electromechanical interfaces 20 on the interchangeable battery pack 14 and on a lower end of a main handle 22 of the hammer drill 10. For this purpose, the operator can insert and lock the electromechanical interface 20 of the interchangeable battery pack 14 into the electromechanical mating interface 20 of the hammer drill

10. It should be noted that the overall design of the electromechanical interfaces **20** of the interlocking battery pack **14** and of the machining device **12** that can be connected thereto, and the associated receptacles for the frictional and/or interlocking releasable connection, are not intended to be the subject of this disclosure. A person skilled in the art will choose a suitable embodiment for the interfaces **20** depending on the power class or voltage class of the machining device **12** and/or of the interchangeable battery pack **14**.

[0024] A housing **24** of the interchangeable battery pack **14** has, on a first side wall or its upper side, the first electromechanical interface **20** for releasable connection to the electromechanical mating interface **20** of the hammer drill **10**. The interchangeable battery pack **14** is discharged during operation of the hammer drill **10**. The voltage class of the interchangeable battery pack **14** results from the connection (parallel or serial) of the individual energy storage cells **26** integrated in the interchangeable battery pack **14** and is usually an integer multiple (≥ 1) of the voltage of the individual energy storage cells **26**. An energy storage cell **26** is typically designed as a galvanic cell which has a structure in which one cell pole comes to lie at one end and a further cell pole comes to lie at an opposite end. In particular, the energy storage cell **26** has a positive cell pole at one end and a negative cell pole at an opposite end. Preferably, the energy storage cells **26** are designed as lithium-based round cells, e.g., Li-ion, Li-cell polymer, Li-metal, or the like, wherein the cell poles are arranged at the ends of the cylinder shape. However, the disclosure can also be applied to Ni—Cd, Ni-Mh cells or other suitable cell types. In the case of common Li-ion energy storage cells **26** with a cell voltage of 3.6 V, voltage classes of 3.6 V, 7.2 V, 10.8 V, 14.4 V, 18 V, 36 V, etc. result, for example. However, the disclosure does not depend on the type and design of the energy storage cells **26** used, but can be applied to any interchangeable battery packs **14** that use prismatic cells, pouch cells or the like instead of round cells. The DC voltage values are primarily based on the typical cell voltages of the energy storage cells **26** used. For pouch cells and/or cells with a different electrochemical composition, for example, voltage values that differ from the voltage values of the interchangeable battery packs **14** equipped with Li-ion cells are possible. In the following, the disclosure is described by way of example for an interchangeable battery pack **14** with a voltage class of 18 V.

[0025] The hammer drill **10** comprises a housing **28** in which a percussion mechanism **30** is at least partially arranged, the percussion mechanism being used to rotationally and/or percussively drive an insertion tool (not shown), such as a drill bit or a chisel, which can be alternately held in a drill chuck **32** arranged at the front end of the hammer drill. The percussion mechanism **30** is driven by an electric motor **34** together with a downstream transmission **36**, the electric motor being arranged in the housing **28** and being supplied with energy by an electronic unit **38**, which consists of a power electronics unit and an open- or closed-loop control unit. The electronic unit **38** is controlled for the closed- or open-loop control of the electric motor **34** according to a main button **40** which can be actuated by the operator, such that a desired speed and/or a desired torque of the electric motor **34** and of the drill chuck **32** driven by the electric motor can be set according to the pressing travel of the main button **40**. The main button **40** is arranged in the main handle **22** of the hammer drill **10**, the main handle being formed essentially by two half shells formed as handle shells **42**. The two handle shells **42** are at least partially covered with a soft component in order to achieve an improved and more comfortable grip for the operator. The soft component is preferably in the form of a thermoplastic elastomer (TPE). Furthermore, the main handle **22** is decoupled from the housing **28** by an attenuating device **44** at the upper part of the main handle such that vibration is damped, in order to protect the operator from excessive vibrations during long work processes. The attenuating device **44** also comprises an articulated connection **46** at the lower end of the main handle **22**, by which articulated connection the main handle **22** is movably coupled to the housing **22**. For better guidance of the hammer drill **10**, an optional additional handle (not shown in the figures) may be provided near the drill chuck **32**. The further the main button **40** is pushed into the main handle **22**, the higher the speed of the electric motor **34** is. When the main button **40** is

released, it automatically moves out and the electric motor **34** comes to a stop. For the speed and/or torque control of the electric motor **34** configured as an EC motor, the open- or closed-loop control unit controls the power bridge by pulse width modulation (PWM) such that the power bridge applies trapezoidal or nearly sinusoidal commutation to the individual phases of the EC motor in a known manner.

[0026] By way of an operating mode selection switch **50** accommodated in the housing **28**, the operator can switch between different operating modes, such as a drilling mode, a hammer drilling mode, or a chiseling or hammering mode. The operator can also use the main button **40** to vary the speed and/or torque of the electric motor **34** and thus of the insertion tool or drill chuck **32** operatively connected by the percussion mechanism **30**. A Human Machine Interface (HMI) **52** provides the operator with a wide range of information, for example about the state of charge of the connected interchangeable battery pack **14**, about the set operating mode and about any operating faults, such as an excessive temperature or the like. Furthermore, the hammer drill **10** comprises an exchangeable or permanently integrated communication module **54** for exchanging data with an external device (not shown in detail in this case), e.g. a smartphone, a smart watch, a personal computer, a gateway, a cloud server, or the like. The communication module **54** can also be used to make various settings on the hammer drill **10**, e.g. activating or deactivating a kickback control mode (KBC) or adaptive speed control, from the external device. For this purpose, the communication module **54** exchanges the data via radio, in particular WLAN, Bluetooth, LoRa, Zigbee, or a comparable data protocol. A further detailed description of the battery-operated machining device **12** designed as a hammer drill **10** is omitted here, as this is only of minor importance regarding the disclosure and the hammer drill **10** is also only to be understood as an example of various battery-operated machining devices **12**.

[0027] According to the sectional view in FIG. 2, the housing **28** of the hammer drill **10** consists, similarly to the main handle **22**, along a central plane **58** extending in the direction of the working axis **16**, of two half shells **60**, which are open on one side and which accommodate the electric motor **34**, the transmission **36** and a part of the percussion mechanism **30** of the hammer drill **10**. After assembly of the hammer drill **10**, the half shells **60** are held together by a plurality of threaded connections (not shown) at their respective, directly adjacent side edges. The housing **28** is adjoined not only by the main handle **22** connected to the housing **28** with vibrational decoupling but also by a housing part **62** surrounding the electronic unit **38**. The housing part **62** consists, similarly to the housing **28** and to the main handle **22**, of two half shells **60**, which in the assembled state form a cup housing which is open on one side and which is interlockingly and/or frictionally connected to the housing **28** by way of a tongue-and-groove system. Alternatively, it is also conceivable that the housing part **62** is configured as a single-piece cup housing. It is also conceivable that the half shells **60** of the housing part **62** and the half shells **60** of the housing **28** form a single-piece construction unit in each case.

[0028] To protect an interchangeable battery pack **14** inserted into the electromagnetic interface **20** of the main handle **22**, a protective housing **64** is fixedly connected to the housing part **62**. The protective housing **64** is movably coupled to the main handle **22** and arranged around the electromechanical interface **20** of the main handle **22** such that the interchangeable battery pack **14** received in the electromechanical interface **20** is completely surrounded by an envelope **66** of the protective housing **56** (cf. also FIGS. 3 and 5 in this regard). Thus, in a particularly advantageous manner, the protective housing **64** can absorb any impacts and falls particularly well by dissipating the impact energy into the housing part **62**, while a high level of vibrational decoupling can be achieved as a result of the movable coupling to the main handle **22**.

[0029] Particularly preferably, the protective housing **64** and the housing part **62** are formed as a single piece in order to better dissipate the impact energy from the protective housing **64** into the housing portion **62**. The protective housing **64** is integrally formed on the housing part **62**, for example in the course of a plastic injection molding process or the like. Alternatively, the protective

housing **64** may also be fixedly connected to the housing part **62** by a frictional connection, in particular a screw connection. All housing elements **22**, **28**, **42**, **60**, **62**, **64** are preferably made of a plastic material, for example PA6GF35, ABS and/or an elastomer. In addition or alternatively, another natural material, a metal (steel, aluminum, etc.) or a mix of materials is also conceivable.

[0030] FIG. **3** shows a perspective partial view of the hammer drill **10** according to the previous FIGS. **1** and **2**, the perspective partial view comprising the main handle **22**, the housing part **62** and the protective housing **64**. For better clarity, no interchangeable battery pack **14** inserted into the electromechanical interface **20** of the main handle **22** is shown in the partial view. In this regard, reference is made to FIGS. **2** and **5**. In addition, due to the spatial representation the designations “left” and “right” have been added to the coordinate cross already used in FIGS. **1** and **2**. For movable coupling to the main handle **22**, the protective housing **64** comprises, on each of at least two outer sides, a contact surface **68** in which a preferably removable support element **70** is arranged such that the support element guides the main handle **22** laterally and supports the protective housing **64** in the event of a fall or impact on the main handle **22**. In this way, a precise machining operation along the working axis **16** of the hammer drill **10** can be ensured, while, in the event of a fall or impact, the impact energy can be dissipated not only into the housing part **62** fixedly connected to the protective housing **64** but also into the main handle **22**. Because the support elements **70** can be removed from the main handle **22** and/or from the protective housing **64**, a simplified way to replace the main handle **22** or the protective housing **64** in the event of a defect is provided. In addition, it is possible to influence the degree of support on the main handle **22**, for example in order to briefly allow very high vibrations without the main handle **22** striking the protective housing **64**.

[0031] For optimized support of the protective housing **64** on the main handle **22**, the contact surfaces **68** of the protective housing **64** are inclined towards the main handle **22**. In the case of a protective housing **64** and/or housing part **62** consisting of two half shells **60**, in the event of a fall or impact the protective housing **64** can thus be pushed towards the central plane **58** of the hammer drill **10** so that the half shells **60** do not gape apart.

[0032] The two support elements **70** are coupled, by way of one retaining element **72** each, to the main handle **22** or to its handle shells **42**. Preferably, the retaining element **72** is in the form of an elastic damping element which consists of an elastomer or a rubber and one end of which engages, with reference to FIG. **4**, in a cylindrical recess **74** of a protrusion **76** of the handle shell **42** through an opening of the support element **70** in the manner of a pin, for the purpose of interlocking and/or frictional connection. However, it is also conceivable that the retaining element **72** is in the form of a screw. For clarity, FIG. **4** shows a section through the protective housing **64** along an axis through the retaining elements **72** perpendicular to the central plane **58**. At its other end, the retaining element **72** comprises a plate-like head **78** for retaining the support element **70** on the handle shell **42**. In this way, the support element **70** can be easily exchanged by laterally pulling it off. Also, any noises in the event of abrupt impact of the support element **70** against the protective housing **64** can be reduced. Alternatively, it can be provided that each support element **70** is fixedly connected, in particular integrally, to a handle shell **42** of the main handle **22**. In this way, it can be ensured that the support element **70** does not become lost. Particularly preferably, the support element **70** and the main handle **22** are then made of the same material.

[0033] The protective housing **64** has, on each of the inner sides of the two outer walls, a honeycomb structure **80** which, in particular, is irregular. This results in a reduced weight of the hammer drill **10** and improved dissipation of the impact energy together with increased intrinsic stability, in comparison with a full-volume or solid protective housing **64**. In regions in which greater stability is required, the honeycombs can be more closely meshed and smaller and may have a structure that deviates from a hexagonal honeycomb structure.

[0034] FIG. **5** shows the protective housing **64** of the hammer drill **10** according to FIGS. **1** to **4** in a top plan view, the protective housing consisting of the two half shells **60**. For better orientation,

the coordinate cross and the working axis **16** are shown similarly to FIGS. **1** to **4**. In contrast to FIGS. **3** and **4**, the interchangeable battery pack **14** is inserted into the electromechanical interface **20** (not shown) of the main handle **22** consisting of the two handle shells **42**. A locking device **82** is provided on the interchangeable battery pack **14**, by way of which locking device the interchangeable battery pack **14** can be secured in the electromechanical interface **20** of the hammer drill **10**, to prevent it from accidentally falling out. However, the exact design of the locking device **82** is not the subject of the disclosure, and therefore this is not to be discussed further.

[0035] As can be clearly seen, the inserted interchangeable battery pack **14** is completely surrounded by the envelope **66** of the protective housing **64**. The protective housing **64** and the main handle **22** are movably coupled to each other by the support elements **70**, which are arranged on the inclined contact surfaces **68** of the protective housing, and by the retaining elements **72**, in the manner previously described.

[0036] Finally, it should be pointed out that the exemplary embodiment shown is not limited to FIGS. **1** to **4**, nor to the hammer drill **10**. These are therefore to be understood only as example.

Claims

1. A battery-operated machining device having an electronic unit and/or an electric motor for operating the machining device, comprising: a housing part which at least partially surrounds the electronic unit and/or the electric motor; a main handle which is movably connected to the housing part and configured for vibrational decoupling; and at least one electromechanical interface which is arranged on the main handle and is configured to receive an interchangeable battery pack such that the interchangeable battery pack is releasable without tools, wherein the electromechanical interface has a protective housing, the envelope of which completely surrounds the received interchangeable battery pack, and wherein the protective housing is fixedly connected to the housing part and movably coupled to the main handle.
2. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 1, wherein the protective housing comprises, for movable coupling to the main handle, a guidance mechanism which is configured to guide the main handle laterally and to support the protective housing on the main handle in the event of a fall or impact.
3. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 2, wherein the protective housing has, on each of at least two outer sides, a contact surface in which the guidance mechanism is arranged as a removable support element.
4. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 3, wherein the contact surfaces of the protective housing are inclined towards the main handle.
5. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 3, wherein at least one of the support elements is coupled to the main handle by way of a retaining element.
6. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 5, wherein the retaining element is in the form of an elastic dampening element or a screw.
7. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 3, wherein at least one of the support elements is fixedly connected to the main handle.
8. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 1, wherein the protective housing and the housing part are formed as a single piece.
9. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 1, wherein the protective housing is fixedly connected to the housing part by a frictional connection.
10. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 1, wherein the housing part and the protective housing each consist of two half shells along a central plane extending in the direction of a working axis of the machining device.
11. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 1, wherein the protective housing

has a honeycomb structure which is irregular.

12. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 3, wherein at least one of the support elements is integrally connected to the main handle.

13. The battery-operated machining device according to claim 9, wherein the protective housing is fixedly connected to the housing part by a screw connection.
